



Collateral damage

Civilians sort through the ruins of their shops and homes in the Chinese quarter of Cholon. The hub of economic activity in the city, Cholon saw some of the fiercest street fighting during the Tet Offensive.

Counterattacks

Reinforcements started to arrive through the morning. By midday on January 31, most of the strategic targets around Saigon had been secured and the attackers had been driven back with heavy casualties. Counterattacks were launched to clear the capital of Viet Cong. There was house-to-house fighting and civilian areas were bombed. It took nearly a month to clear Cholon of Viet Cong forces, but within a week American and South Vietnamese forces had recaptured the rest of Saigon and repelled NVA and Viet Cong attacks on most of the communist targets in the South.

The offensive caused immense destruction and heavy loss of civilian life, but no popular insurrection against the South Vietnamese government took place. In total, an estimated 45,000 NVA and Viet Cong troops were killed, captured, or wounded.